

Figure 2.7 Cotton Cultivation and Harvesting

of fibres, 62 kg of seeds and 3 kg of waste. The lint's are compressed into bundles of 500 kg and sent to spinning mills for yarn production.

2.2.4 Characteristics of Cotton

Luster	Low
Tenacity / Strength	Medium
Elastic Recovery	Low
Elongation	7%
Resiliency	Low
Density	1.54 g / cm^3
Moisture Absorption	8.5%
Dimensional Stability	Good
Reaction with Acid	Weakens fibres
Reaction with Alkalies	Resistant (Mercerization)
Effect of Sunlight	Weakens fibres slowly
Insects	Silverfish damages the fibre
Reaction to Flame	Burns readily
Shape	Straw like Structure
Width	12 – 29 mm
Length	1.25 – 6 cm
Colour	White, Cream White
Drying	Quick and Good
Dyeing	Good Absorption

2.2.5 Common Uses of Cotton

- Clothing (Frocks, Socks, Towels, Saree, Dress Materials).
- Household Textiles (Bed Spread, Pillows).
- Medical Textiles (Absorbance Pads, Bandages).

Animal Fibres

The animal fibres are obtained from animals or insects in the form of hair or a liquid substance like saliva. It is full of protein. Example : Hair from the goat (Kashmir goat), camel, rabbit and saliva of silk worm.

DO YOU KNOW?

Which is the strongest natural fiber?

The strongest natural fiber is spider silk. It is the toughest fiber. It is light, flexible fiber but at the same time it is five times stronger by weight than graded steel.



Spider Web

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